Parts

JULY 31, 2026



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One of the primary benefits of using a CMMS is the ability to track costs associated with Equipment and Work Orders. Accurate cost tracking helps organizations budget for future expenses, analyze historical spending, and make informed maintenance decisions.
In AIMS 3, this is accomplished with Parts refer to the materials needed to complete work. Maintenance activities. This can include a replacement component used to repair a failure or a Part Kit used during routine preventive maintenance. To ensure accurate reporting and cost analysis, all Parts regardless of value or size should be properly documented within the system.

Special Note About Inheritance
AIMS 3 includes an inheritance feature that allows records to automatically inherit settings and information from related records. For example, if a Part or Part Kit is added at the Model level, all associated Equipment records can inherit that information. This eliminates the need to manually add the same data to individual assets, saving time, reducing administrative effort, and improving data consistency throughout the system.

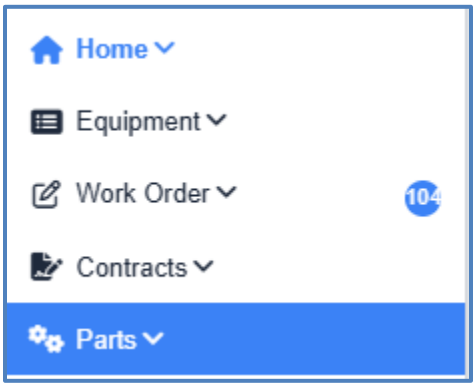
Inventoried Parts vs. Parts-on-the-Fly
AIMS 3 provides two methods for tracking Parts usage. Organizations can maintain a complete Parts inventory within the CMMS, allowing Parts to be categorized, tracked, and reported on consistently. Alternatively, users can add Parts-on-the-Fly directly to a Work Order by entering a description, quantity used, and cost per item.

While Parts-on-the-Fly provide flexibility and are often quicker to enter, they can result in inconsistent descriptions, duplicate entries, and reporting inaccuracies. Whenever possible, organizations should maintain an inventory of commonly used, critical, or high-cost Parts. Even managing a portion of the inventory can significantly improve data quality, inventory visibility, and cost reporting.

Workflow Standardization
Organizations often have multiple administrators and users responsible for maintaining Parts data. Without clear standards, inconsistencies can develop over time, reducing the accuracy and value of reporting.
It is important to establish guidelines for when inventoried Parts, Part Kits, and Parts-on-the-Fly should be used. For example, a specialty Part that will never be used again may be more appropriate as a Part-on-the-Fly entry, while frequently used Parts should be maintained within inventory. Consistent data-entry practices improve reporting accuracy, inventory management, and overall system effectiveness. Phoenix Data Systems can assist organizations with workflow reviews and best-practice recommendations to help maximize the value of their AIMS 3 implementation.

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Overview



The Parts component is in the navigation menu on the left side of the screen, directly below Contracts. Selecting the drop-down arrow next to Parts displays additional options, including List View and Part Kits.
Selecting List View displays a complete list of Parts available in the system. Clicking either the Parts icon or the Parts menu item opens the last Part record viewed by the user in the main workspace.

Within a Part record, users will find three primary areas:

- Part Menu Bar
- Part Details Section
- Additional Tabs

Each tab contains groups of fields designed to capture specific information about the Part. These fields may include dropdown selections, free-text fields, checkboxes, numeric fields, and date/time fields depending on the type of information being recorded.

Note: Fields marked with a red asterisk (*) are required and must be completed before the record can be saved. Additional fields can be configured as required through System Setup based on your organization's needs.

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The Parts Menu Bar

The Part Menu Bar provides quick access to common actions and tools used throughout the Parts module. While many of the icons are familiar and easy to recognize, users can view a description of any button by simply hovering their cursor over the icon.





Save – Allows the User to Save a Part once the required fields have been populated.

New – Creates a new Part.



Duplicate – Duplicates the existing Part.



Delete – Deletes the Saved or Unsaved Part.



Undo – Returns the Unsaved Part to the previous save point.



First – Navigates to the first Part record in the Parts List.



Previous – Navigates to the previous Part record in the Parts List.



Next – Navigates to the previous Part record in the Parts List.



Last – Navigates to the last Part record in the Parts List.



Vendor Directory – Opens the Vendor Directory and displays all available information about the Vendor. This information is added through the Data Managers component.



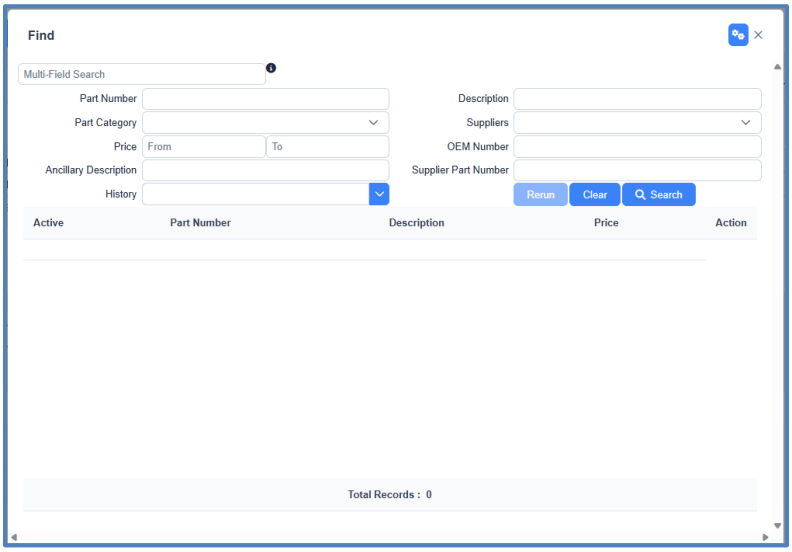
Find – Opens the Search Query screen where a single Part record or multiple Part records can be filtered.

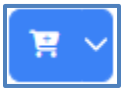
The Part Find window allows users to search for Parts using a variety of available Part fields. Search results are displayed at the bottom of the window after clicking the Search button.

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The History section stores the ten most recent searches performed by each user, along with the number of results returned for each search. Users can quickly rerun a previous search by selecting it from the list and clicking Rerun. When a search is rerun, the results are refreshed using the current data in the system, and the search is moved to the top of the History list rather than creating a duplicate entry.

Using the History feature can save time when performing frequently used searches and provides quick access to commonly viewed Parts records.

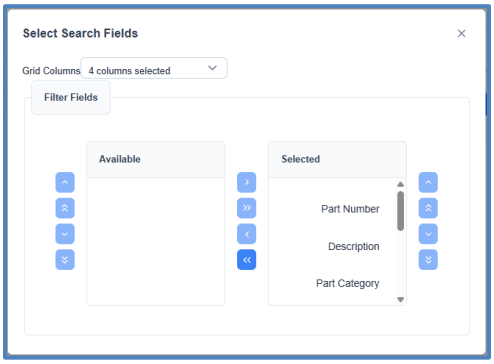




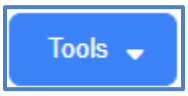
Purchase Request – Creates a Purchase Request from a Part. For more information about this functionality, see Appendix A: Purchase Request



Setup – Users can adjust which fields and grids are visible by clicking the Select Search Fields button in the upper right corner of the window.



The dropdown “Grid Columns” allows the User to change the information viewed in the results grid. The Contract Filters changes which field the User can search. These changes are User specific.



Tools – Allows the User to conduct advanced functions regarding the Parts.

Note: Depending on a User’s access, they will see all, some, or none of the following items!

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Associate Models – Allows the User to associate the Part with one or more Models. Selecting this option will produce a popup where the User selects the Manufacturer and Model. Clicking the Add button links the Part to the Model.



Change Part Number – Allows Users to change the Part Number.

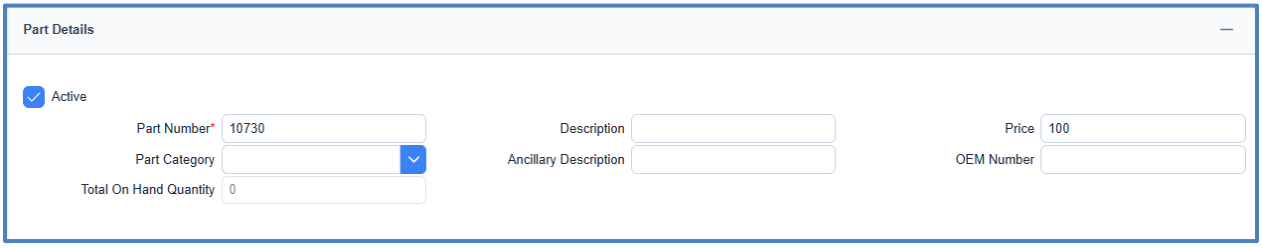
Note: Changing the Part Number in the Part Number field will change the record to the corresponding Part. If the Part Number does not exist in the system, the screen will change to add a part.



Merge Part Number – Allows Users to merge two Parts.

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The Part Details Section



The **Part Details** section contains the core information for each Part record. Accurate and complete data in this section helps improve inventory tracking, purchasing, reporting, and maintenance planning.

Part Number – *(User Defined Text)*
The unique identifier used to distinguish the Part from all other Parts in the system. Organizations should establish a consistent numbering convention to improve searchability and reporting.
Description – *(Free Text)*
A clear, detailed description of the Part. This information helps users quickly identify the correct Part when searching or creating Work Orders.
Price – *(Decimal)*
The current cost of the Part. This value is used for cost tracking, inventory valuation, and Work Order reporting.

Part Category – *(Dropdown)*
Used to classify the Part into a specific category for organization and reporting purposes. Examples may include:

- Battery
- Belt
- Filter
- Circuit Board

Organizations may create additional categories to meet their inventory management needs.

Ancillary Description – *(Free Text)*
An alternative or supplemental description of the Part, often provided by a manufacturer, supplier, catalog, or distributor.
OEM Number – *(User Defined Text)*
The Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) part number. This field is commonly used when the organization's Part Number differs from the manufacturer's identifier.
Total On-Hand Quantity – *(Calculated Field)*
Displays the current quantity available in inventory. This value is automatically calculated based on inventory transactions such as receipts, issues, adjustments, and transfers.

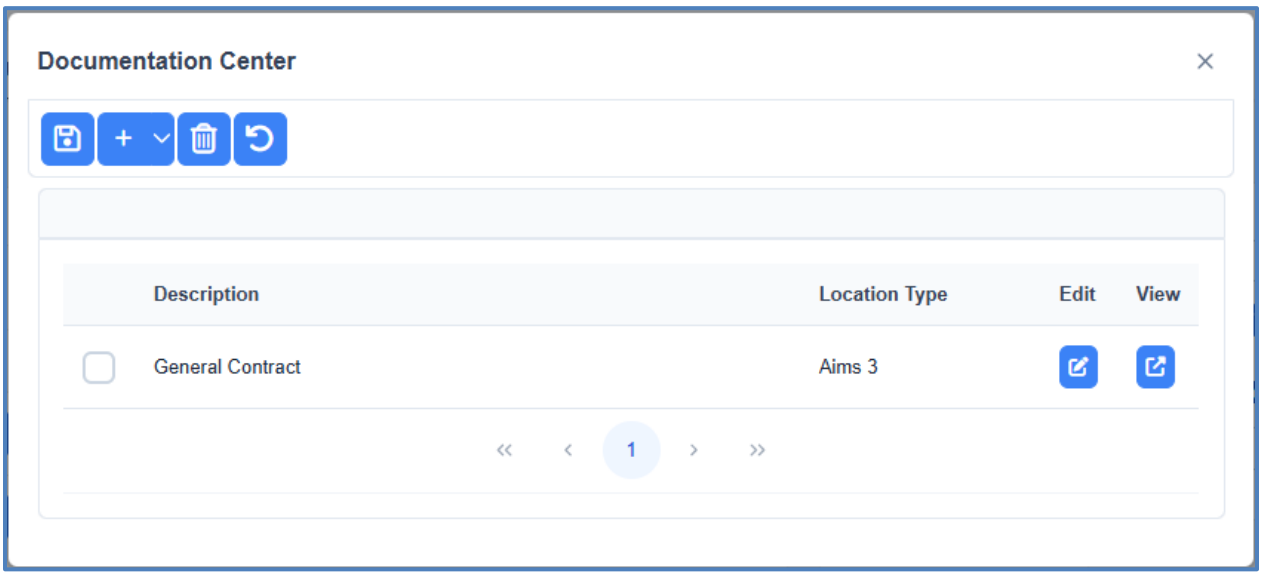
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Documentation Center

The Documentation Center allows users to attach files directly to a Part record, such as manuals, specification sheets, warranty information, safety data sheets (SDS), images, vendor.

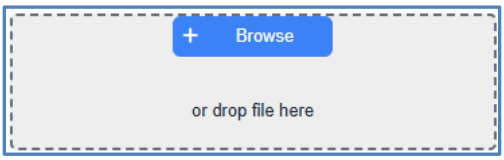
documentation, or other supporting files. Selecting **List Attachments** displays all files currently associated with the Part.

Best Practice: Attach manufacturer documentation and specification sheets whenever possible. This information can help technicians quickly identify replacement Parts, verify compatibility, and reduce maintenance downtime.



Save - Saves the attachment.

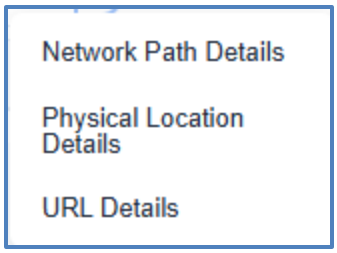
New – Adds a new attachment. When the plus is clicked the window will include a section on the right side to “Browse” for the file or Users can drag and drop the file in the “File Details” section.



Note: On mobile devices, browsing files will present the user with three options: taking a photo, selecting a photo from the Photo Library, or accessing the devices files application.

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Clicking the drop-down arrow  provides additional options



for associating documentation with the Part record. Users can:

- Enter a network path to a file stored on a shared network drive.
- Record the physical location of a document, such as a file cabinet, storage room, or binder.
- Enter a hyperlink to documentation stored on an external website, cloud storage location, or vendor portal.

These options allow organizations to maintain references to important documentation without storing every file directly within AIMS 3, ensuring users can quickly locate supporting information when needed.



Delete – Deletes the Saved or Unsaved attachment.



Undo – Returns the Unsaved attachment to the previous save point.

Notes: This text area has been provided to add any notes regarding the Part.

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Additional Tabs

Us The additional tabs within a Part record allow users to capture and manage detailed information related to inventory, purchasing, and Part activity. Common tabs include:

- Suppliers
- Warehouses
- Transaction Log

Not every field must be completed, even though some fields may be required. Organizations should determine the appropriate balance between collecting useful information and minimizing data-entry effort. When developing Parts workflows, administrators should consider whether the value gained from future reporting and analysis justifies the time required to enter additional data. Documenting these standards helps ensure consistency across all users and administrators.

Suppliers - The Suppliers tab stores vendor information for the Part and allows organizations to maintain relationships with multiple suppliers. To add a supplier, click the Add (+) button. In the popup window, the only required field is Supplier. Additional supplier information may include:

- Part Number
- Description
- Exchangeable Part – Indicates the supplier requires the used or defective part to be returned for credit or refurbishment.

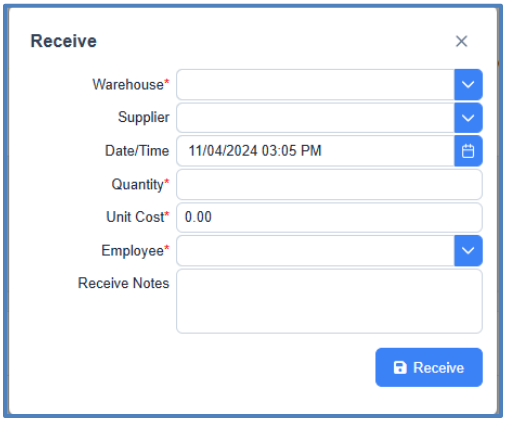
Under the Order Information section, users can also define:

- Quantity Per Unit
- Unit of Measure
- Minimum Order Quantity
- List Price
- Delivery Lead Time (Days).

Warehouses - The Warehouses tab displays all warehouse locations where the Part is stocked and provides tools for managing inventory transactions.
Common inventory transactions include:
Receive – Adds inventory to a warehouse location. After completing the required fields and selecting Receive, the inventory is added to stock.
When receiving inventory, users can specify:

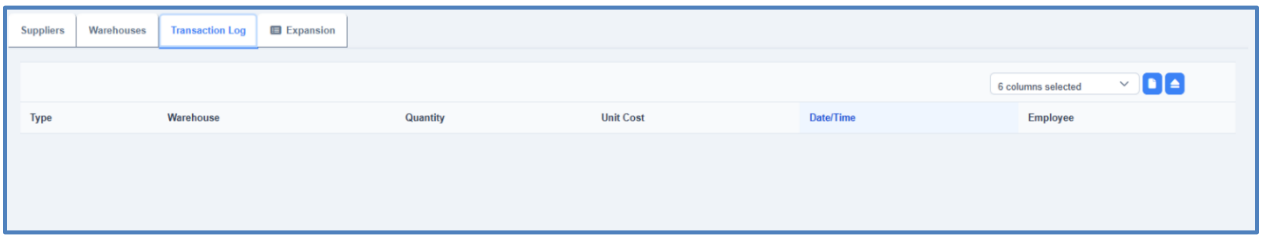
- Warehouse receiving the inventory
- Supplier
- Date and Time Received
- Quantity Received
- Unit Cost

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- Transfer – Allows users to move inventory between warehouse locations. To complete a transfer, users must specify the From Warehouse, To Warehouse, Quantity, and Unit Cost. Selecting Transfer updates, the inventory quantities in both warehouses and records the transaction in the system.
- Adjust – Allows users to correct inventory quantities to match physical inventory counts. Users must first select the warehouse to be adjusted. The system displays the Current Quantity on hand. The Adjust Quantity field accepts both positive and negative values, allowing users to increase or decrease inventory as needed. Once a value is entered, the Quantity After Adjustment field is automatically calculated. Selecting Adjust saves inventory correction and records the transaction.

Transaction Log - The Transaction Log is a read-only tab that displays a complete history of inventory activity for the Part. This includes transactions such as receipts, transfers, adjustments, and Part usage.



Expansion Tab – No CMMS can anticipate every organization's data requirement. The Expansion tab allows administrators to create custom field sets and fields to capture information unique to their workflows. While these custom fields are typically created within the Expansion tab, they can also be displayed in the record header (nameplate) for easier visibility and access.

Custom fields provide flexibility to meet operational, reporting, accreditation, and regulatory requirements without modifying the core application.

Create a Field set

To create a custom field set:

1. Right-click within the blue area below the tab bar.
2. Select + Add Field set.
3. Enter a name for the new field set.
4. Click OK to create the field set.

Field sets help organize custom fields into logical groups, making records easier to manage and navigate.

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Customizing a Field set

After a field set has been created, right-click on the field set to access additional options:

- Field set – Rename or delete the field set.
- + Add Field – Add custom fields to the field set.

When adding a field, users can choose from various field types to accommodate different data requirements. Right-clicking on an existing custom field provides options to Edit or Delete the field.

Required Fields and Header Display

When editing a custom field, administrators can configure additional settings, including:

- Required – Makes the field mandatory before the record can be saved.
- Add to Header – Displays the field in the record header (nameplate) for quick visibility.

Fields added to the header can be rearranged to match organizational workflows and priorities.

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List View

The List View feature is a powerful tool for viewing, searching, and managing Part records within AIMS 3. It can be accessed from the Parts section of the navigation menu.

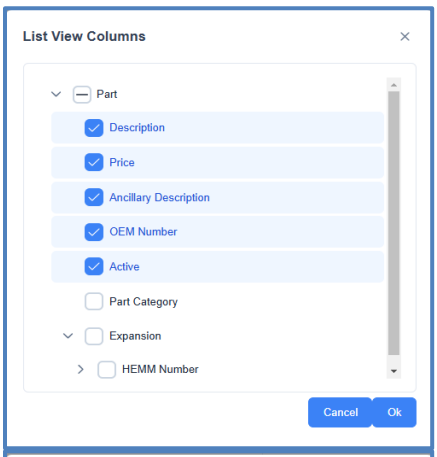


Each row in the List View contains a clickable Part Number that opens the corresponding Part record. The Refresh button in the upper-left corner updates the list and displays the most current information available in the system.

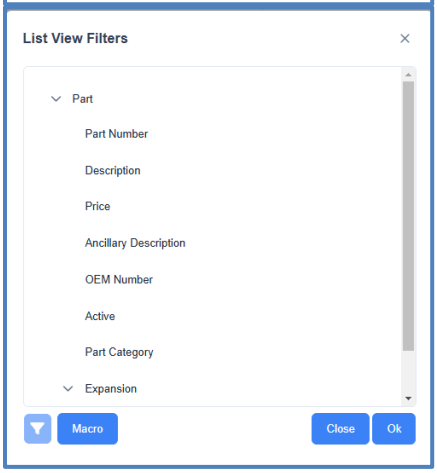
The Tool Bar – The toolbar contains several tools that allow users to customize, filter, and export data displayed in the List View



Select Columns – Allows users to choose which columns are displayed in the List View. Column selections are user-specific and do not affect other users. Once selected, the column layout remains in place until the user changes it again. After selecting the desired columns, click **OK** to apply the changes.



Filter – Allows users to refine the records displayed in the List View. Clicking Filter opens a window containing available fields that can be used as filter criteria. Users can select a field, define the desired filter options, and click OK to apply the filter. Selecting Clear removes the filter criteria.



The Filter window also includes a Macro option. Users can save frequently used filter settings as Macros for quick access in the future. Existing Macros can be loaded and applied at any time.

- Global – Makes the Macro available to all users.
- Not Global – Allows the creator to share the Macro with specific users.

Using Macros can significantly reduce the time required to perform frequently used searches and reporting tasks.

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Export – Exports the current List View results to a Microsoft Excel file. Only records displayed in the current view, including any active filters, are exported.

Popout View – Opens the current List View in a separate window while retaining the same data, filters, and column selections. This feature is useful when users need to reference a list while working in another record.

The Popout View includes the same tools available in the standard List View:

- Refresh
- Select Columns
- Filter
- Export

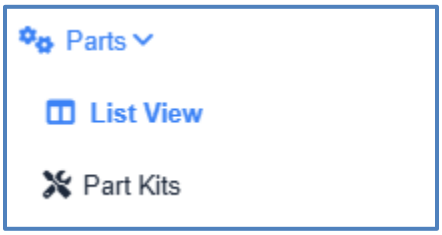
Selecting the part number within the Popout View opens the selected Part record in the original AIMS 3 window. The Popout View also displays the date and time of the last refresh at the bottom of the window, helping users verify the data is current.

Best Practice: Use Filters and Macros together to create personalized views for common inventory tasks, such as viewing Parts by category, warehouse, supplier, or low-stock status. This can improve efficiency and make inventory management easier.

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Part Kits



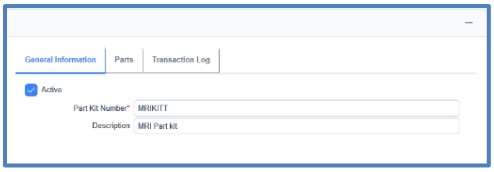
Part Kits provide a convenient way to group Parts that are commonly used together into a single record. For example, a routine vehicle oil change may require several quarts of oil, an oil filter, and, in some cases, an air filter. Rather than adding each Part individually to a Work Order, administrators can create a Part Kit containing all required components.

When a Part Kit is applied to a Work Order, all associated Parts are automatically added to the Work Order. If a specific Part is not needed for a particular job, it can be removed from the Work Order without affecting the original Part Kit configuration. This allows organizations to standardize maintenance procedures while maintaining flexibility for individual tasks.

Using Part Kits can improve efficiency, reduce data-entry time, and help ensure technicians consistently use the correct materials during maintenance activities.

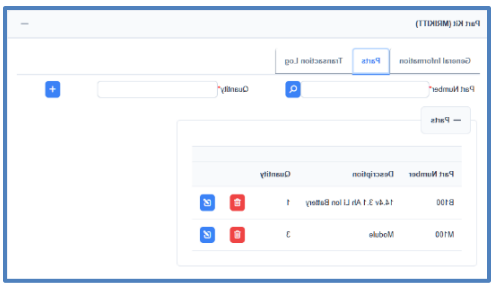
The Part Kit record contains three tabs:

- **General Information** – Contains the basic information and identifying details for the Part Kit.
- **Parts** – Displays the Parts included in the kit and the quantity of each Part that will be added when the kit is applied.
- **Transaction Log** – Provides a read-only history of transactions associated with the Part Kit.



General Information – This section includes the Part Kit Number (User Defined String) and the Description.

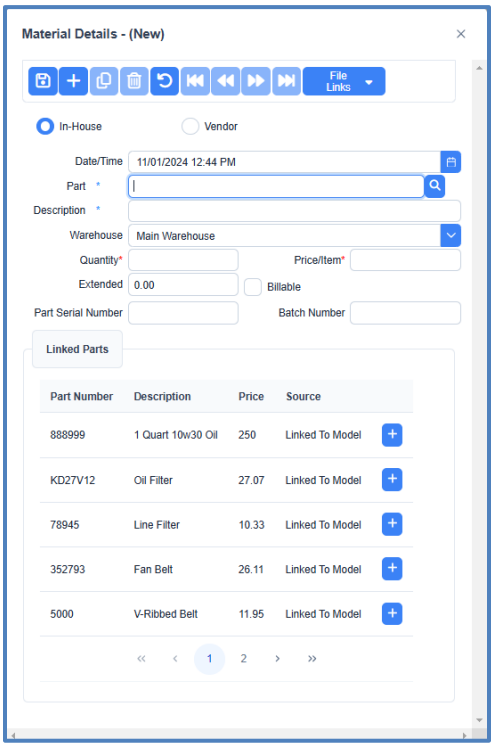
Parts – Here, the Administrator includes all the Parts in the Part Kit. Administrators must declare a Part Number or use the Find tool to locate the desired Part. Next, Administrators need to declare a quantity and click the “Add” button. Administrators can add as many Parts as are needed.



Transaction Log – The Transaction Log is a read-only tab which shows all transactions regarding the Part Kit.

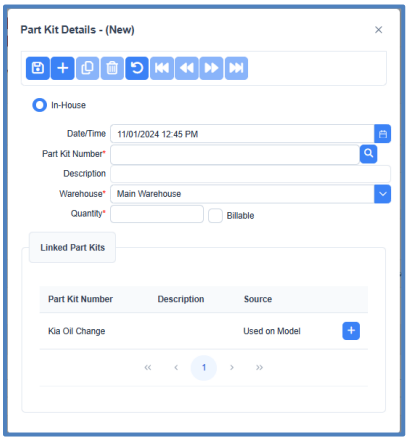
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Applying Material to a Work Order



Apply a Material – Allows users to apply a Part directly to a Work Order.

- **Part Source** – Indicates whether the Part came from inventory (**In-House**) or was purchased from a **Vendor**.
- **Date/Time** – The date and time the Part was applied.
- **Part or Description** – One of these fields is required.
  - **Part** – Select an inventoried Part from AIMS 3.
  - **Description** – Used when a Part record does not exist in AIMS 3. Using a description-only entry will not affect inventory quantities.
- **Warehouse** – The warehouse where the Part was issued from.
- **Quantity** – Number of Parts used.
- **Price/Item** – Cost of each Part.
- **Extended Cost** – Quantity × Price/Item.
- **Billable –** Indicates whether the Part cost is billable.
- **Part Serial Number –** Serial number of the Part, if applicable.
- **Batch Number –** Manufacturing batch or lot number.
- **Linked Parts –** Displays previously used Parts associated with the Equipment.



Apply Part Kit – Applying a Part Kit automatically adds all Parts contained within the kit to the Work Order. If a Part is not needed, it can be removed from the Work Order and returned to inventory without affecting the original Part Kit.

- **Part Source – Indicates whether the Parts came from inventory or a vendor.**
- **Date/Time – The date and time the Part Kit was applied.**
- **Part Kit Number – The Part Kit identifier in AIMS 3.**
- **Description – Description of the Part Kit.**
- **Warehouse – The warehouse supplying the Parts.**
- **Quantity – Number of Part Kits used.**
- **Billable – Indicates whether the Part cost is billable.**
- **Linked Parts – Displays previously used Part Kits associated with the Equipment.**

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Home Screen Widgets

Pending Purchase Order Approvals

The Pending Purchase Order Approval widget displays all Purchase Orders that are awaiting approval before they can be ordered. Information displayed in the widget includes:

- PO Number
- Buyer (Requester)
- Date Needed
- Total Line-Item Cost
- Not-to-Exceed Value

Once a Purchase Order has been approved, it is automatically removed from the widget.

Note: This widget is only visible to users who have been designated as Purchase Order Approvers within AIMS 3.



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Pending Purchase Request Approvals

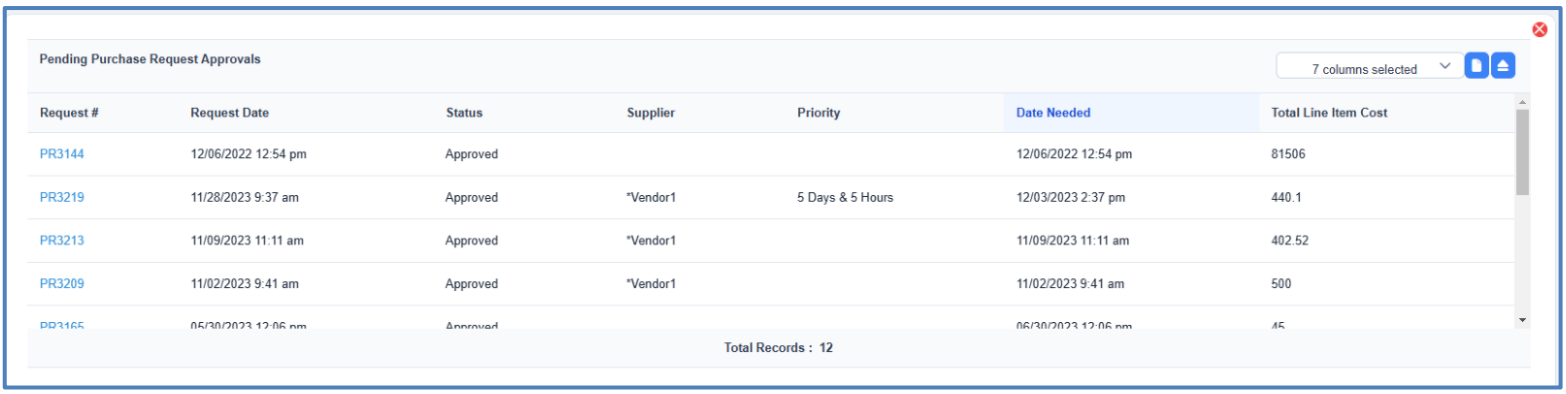
The Pending Purchase Approval widget displays Purchase Requests that have been approved and are progressing through the purchasing process. Information displayed in the widget includes:

- Request Number
- Request Date
- Status
- Supplier
- Priority
- Date Needed
- Total Line-Item Cost
-

The widget also includes a Columns Selected option, which allows users to customize the information displayed by adding or removing columns based on their preferences. This helps users focus on the data most relevant to their purchasing responsibilities.

Helpful Tip: Column selections are user-specific and do not affect the views of other users.

Note: This widget is only visible to users who have been designated as Purchase Request Approvers within AIMS 3. Users without this permission will not see the widget on their Home Screen.



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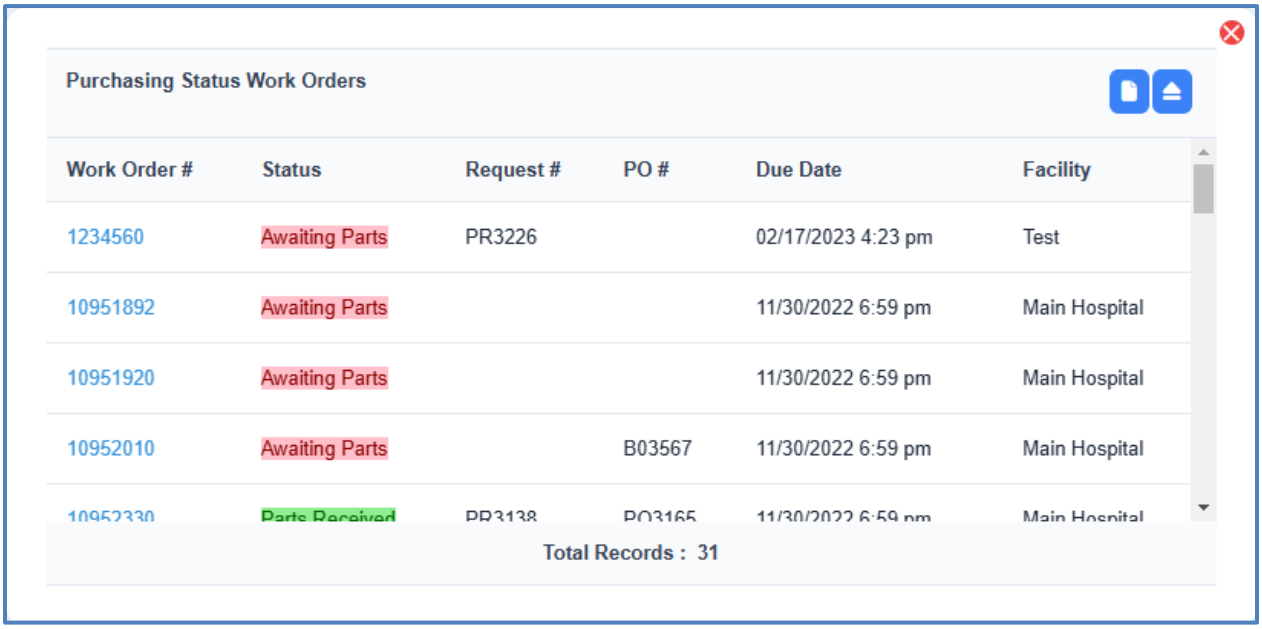
Purchasing Status Work Orders

The **Purchasing Status Work Orders** widget displays all Work Orders that are waiting on Parts and groups them by purchasing status:

- **Parts Received** – All required Parts have been received.
- **Some Parts Received** – Only a portion of the required Parts have been received.
- **Awaiting Parts** – No required Parts have been received.

The status indicators are color-coded to help users quickly identify which Work Orders are ready to proceed and which are still waiting for materials.

Each Work Order includes a Hyperlink on the work order number that opens the selected Work Order record, allowing users to review details, update progress, or manage purchasing information.

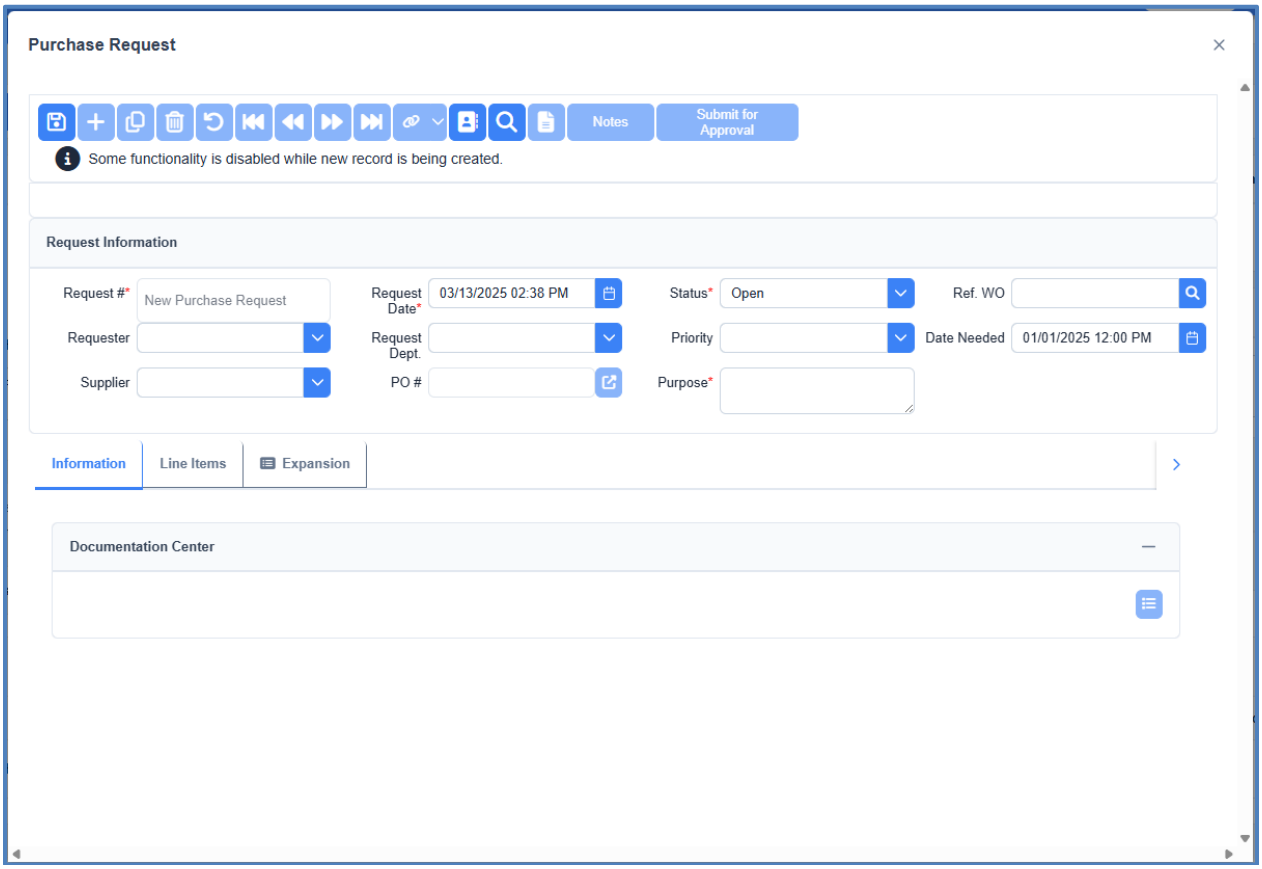


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Appendix A: Purchase Request

If a Part is not in stock, it must be requested. In addition, it is helpful to know from which Work Order the request came when the Part arrives. Purchase Requests can help Administrators keep track of this through the submenu item “Purchase Requests” under Purchasing. Once the Administrator has reviewed the Purchase Request, they can approve them and create Purchase Orders. Purchase Requests can be made through the “New” function from within the Purchase Request submenu, but they can be created from the Parts Menu Bar.

From a Part, Users can create a Purchase Request from the Menu Bar. 



In the popup window, the User will see the Purchase Request Menu Bar, the Request Information Section, and the Line Items tab.

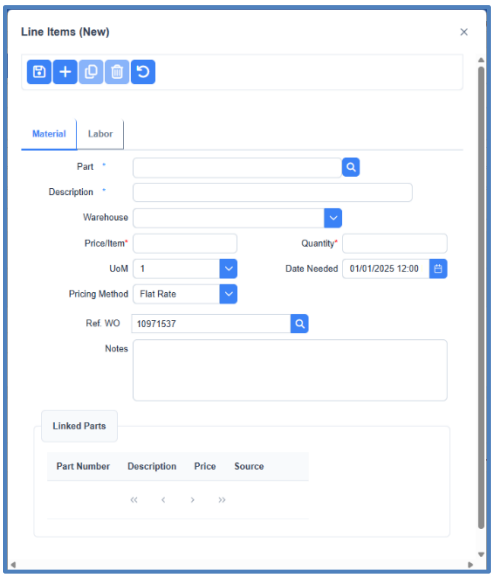
Request Information

When a Purchase Request is created from a Work Order or Part record, portions of the Request Information section may be automatically populated. Users can then enter additional details as needed, including:

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- **Supplier –** Identifies the preferred supplier for the requested material.
- **Purpose –** Provides additional information about why the material is needed, especially when the reason is not apparent from the Work Order.
- After completing the Request Information section, the Purchase Request must be **saved** before Line Items can be added.

Line Items



To add a Line Item to a Purchase Request, click the Add button within the Line Items tab. This will open a new window where the Part information can be entered.

If the Part already exists in AIMS 3, enter or select the Part Number. If the Part does not exist in the system or will not be tracked in inventory, users can enter a Description instead.

Note: Users can enter temporary information in this area and can be changed later either on the Work or Purchase Orders.

Note: Part and Description are accompanied by a blue asterisk. This means one of the fields must be completed to add the line to the Request.

After entering the Part information, users can optionally select a Warehouse where the Part will be received. Users must also enter:

- Price Per Item
- Quantity
-

If the Purchase Request was created from a Work Order, the associated Work Order information is automatically populated. If not, the Work Order can be entered manually.

Clicking the Save button adds the line to the Purchase Request.

For the full Purchasing functionality, see the How-To “Purchasing.”

Note: If configured by the Administrator, this functionality will produce a Purchase Order instead of a Purchase Request. For more information on this functionality, see the How-Tos “System Setup” and “Purchasing.”

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Conclusion

The Parts component in AIMS 3 provides organizations with the tools needed to effectively manage inventory, track material usage, and control maintenance-related costs. Features such as inventory management, warehouse transactions, Part Kits, Purchase Requests, and reporting capabilities help ensure Parts are available when needed while supporting accurate budgeting and operational planning.

Establishing clear and consistent Parts management workflows is essential for maintaining accurate inventory records, improving purchasing efficiency, supporting regulatory compliance, and promoting equipment reliability and patient safety.

If your organization requires additional training, workflow consulting, or implementation assistance, Phoenix Data Systems is available to help. Please contact your Project Manager or the Phoenix Data Systems team for more information about available services and support options.

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Appendix B: Parts Component Course.

To support your learning, we have created a step-by-step video guide that visually walks you through the entire process. Simply click the link below to visit our YouTube channel, where you can watch the full Parts Component Course of tutorials at your own pace. This is a great way to follow along, review key steps, and build confidence with the workflow as you learn.

Parts Component

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